

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Hospitality and Tourism English

Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Arrival before check-in

02 A noise complaint

03 Overbooking plan

04 Rate strategy

05 Room out of order

06 Banquet run of show

07 Tour disruption

08 Service preferences

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Arrival before check-in

Front desk and housekeeping coordinate an early arrival.

Roles: Front-desk agent / Housekeeping supervisor

Front-desk agent: Our group arrived an hour early. Do we have any inspected rooms ready?

Housekeeping supervisor: Six are clean, but only four have passed inspection. I'll confirm those room numbers.

Front-desk agent: I'll offer luggage storage and explain that the remaining rooms are still being prepared.

Housekeeping supervisor: Please don't issue keys for the two uninspected rooms yet.

Front-desk agent: Understood. Can you give me a time for the next room-status update?

Housekeeping supervisor: I'll update the property-management system after inspection and call you if any room is delayed.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Our group arrived an hour early. Do we have any inspected rooms ready?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

A noise complaint

Guest relations follows up on an overnight complaint.

Roles: Guest-relations agent / Duty manager

Guest-relations agent: A guest says corridor noise kept them awake, and their first call wasn't followed up.

Duty manager: Acknowledge both the disturbance and the missed response. Have we checked the incident log?

Guest-relations agent: Yes. The call was logged, but no follow-up action was recorded.

Duty manager: I'll investigate that gap. What remedy falls within your current service-recovery authority?

Guest-relations agent: I can offer the approved options, subject to availability, and ask which would help.

Duty manager: Good. Record the agreed response and check back with the guest afterward.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Acknowledge both the disturbance and the missed response. Have we checked the incident log?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Overbooking plan

Reservations and the duty manager review an overbooked night.

Roles: Reservations supervisor / Duty manager

Reservations supervisor: We have two more confirmed bookings than available rooms after the maintenance closure.

Duty manager: Verify the inventory and follow our relocation policy before contacting any guest.

Reservations supervisor: A nearby partner hotel has rooms, but I haven't confirmed transport or the rate arrangement.

Duty manager: Confirm the complete arrangement and any accessibility requirements first.

Reservations supervisor: I'll prepare accurate options and identify who will speak with the affected guests.

Duty manager: I'll approve the response within our policy and make sure the handoff reaches the receiving hotel.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "We have two more confirmed bookings than available rooms after the maintenance closure." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Rate strategy

A hotel reviews rates for a busy weekend.

Roles: Revenue manager / Sales manager

Revenue manager: Pickup is strong, but the group inquiry would use our remaining large rooms at a lower rate.

Sales manager: The group also brings meeting-space and banquet revenue. Have you included that contribution?

Revenue manager: Not yet. I'll compare total revenue and displacement on the same dates.

Sales manager: Include the tentative rooming list and the cancellation terms.

Revenue manager: Then we can assess the offer against forecast demand rather than occupancy alone.

Sales manager: I'll keep the proposal provisional until we've agreed on the complete commercial terms.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The group also brings meeting-space and banquet revenue. Have you included that contribution?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Room out of order

Housekeeping reports a maintenance issue.

Roles: Housekeeping supervisor / Maintenance coordinator

Housekeeping supervisor: Room 214 has a leaking fixture. I've marked it out of order and notified the desk.

Maintenance coordinator: Is the affected area contained under our procedure, and do we have access?

Housekeeping supervisor: The room is vacant. I'll send the work order and observed condition.

Maintenance coordinator: I'll assess the repair before estimating when it can return to inventory.

Housekeeping supervisor: Let me know when cleaning and inspection can follow.

Maintenance coordinator: I'll update the work order; maintenance completion alone won't mark the room guest-ready.

Notice the professional language

out of order - A room or item unavailable for normal use because of a problem or required work.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Banquet run of show

An event team coordinates a late agenda change.

Roles: Banquet captain / Event coordinator

Banquet captain: The keynote has moved fifteen minutes later. Does dinner service move with it?

Event coordinator: The client wants starters served before the speech and mains afterward.

Banquet captain: I'll check kitchen timing. We also need a clear cue for clearing plates.

Event coordinator: I'll add the revised cues to the run of show and brief audiovisual staff.

Banquet captain: Please confirm the final guest count and dietary information through the agreed list.

Event coordinator: I'll issue one revised version so every team follows the same schedule.

Notice the professional language

run of show - A timed sequence of an event's activities and responsibilities.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Tour disruption

A tour operator responds to a closed attraction.

Roles: Tour guide / Operations coordinator

Tour guide: The museum has closed unexpectedly. The group is due there at two.

Operations coordinator: We need to verify an alternative that fits the group's access needs and available time.

Tour guide: The riverside option would involve more walking. I shouldn't assume that suits everyone.

Operations coordinator: Correct. I'll check transport and availability for the indoor alternative.

Tour guide: I'll explain the confirmed closure and tell the group when to expect the revised plan.

Operations coordinator: I'll confirm arrangements before you present them as booked.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The museum has closed unexpectedly. The group is due there at two." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Service preferences

Two staff members plan service for an international business group.

Roles: Guest-relations manager / Restaurant supervisor

Guest-relations manager: The organizer asked for a quieter seating area and a shorter lunch service.

Restaurant supervisor: Let's confirm the actual preferences rather than infer them from where the group comes from.

Guest-relations manager: I'll ask about timing, dietary needs, and whether they want individual or shared ordering.

Restaurant supervisor: I can offer two service formats with clear timings.

Guest-relations manager: We'll send those options and record the organizer's choice.

Restaurant supervisor: I'll brief the team on the confirmed arrangements without making assumptions about individual guests.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The organizer asked for a quieter seating area and a shorter lunch service." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

SHARED CASE

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

SHARED CASE

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

Role A | Responding professional

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

Useful expressions

In [specific situation], I noticed

The effect was What was happening from your perspective?

Could we agree to ... and review it ...?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Second round

The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

SHARED CASE

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

Role A | Responding professional

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Useful expressions

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Cover this until after your first attempt

The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Second round

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Revenue Management and Pricing

SHARED CASE

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

SHARED CASE

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

SHARED CASE

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

SHARED CASE

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

SHARED CASE

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.